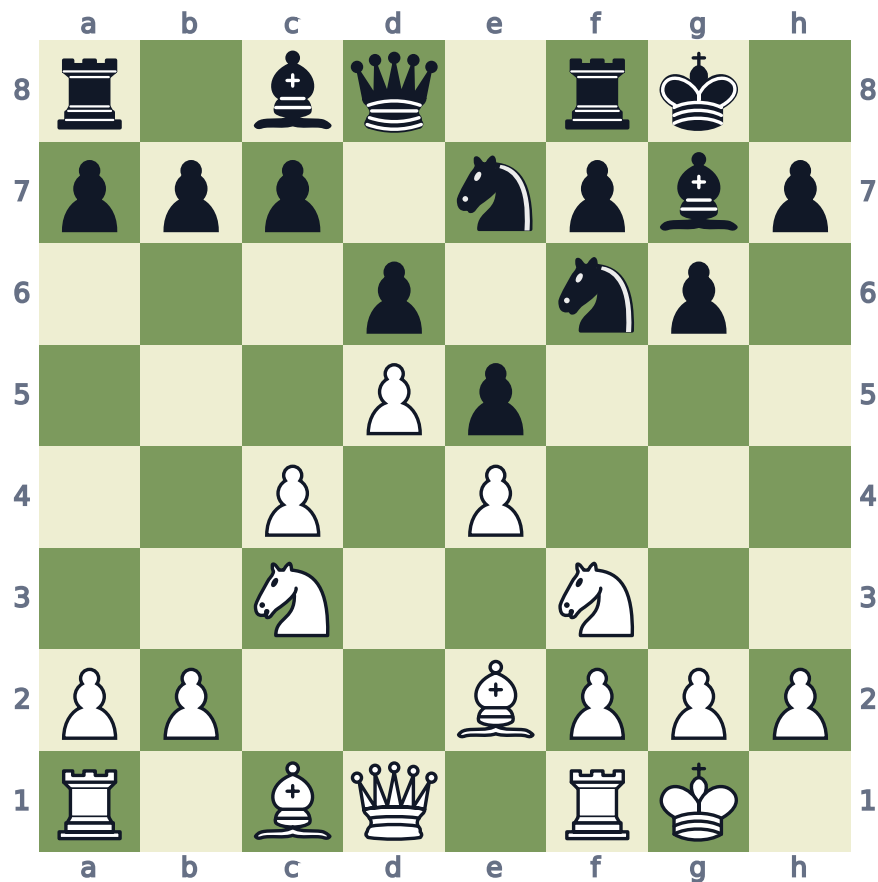


King's Indian Defense Repertoire

Classical development, closed-center races, queenside breaks, and kingside defense



Play the Classical King's Indian with a clear map for the center, the two-wing race, and Black's ...f5 attack.

8 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Play the Classical King's Indian with a clear map for the center, the two-wing race, and Black's ...f5 attack.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

After ...e5 and d5, pawn chains point White toward the queenside and Black toward the kingside.

PRINCIPLE 2

The break c5 is White's main source of open files and targets.

PRINCIPLE 3

Black's ...f5 is not a threat to fear abstractly; calculate its opening of lines.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Bayonet play with b4 requires development and tactical control.

PRINCIPLE 5

When Black plays ...c5, the position may transpose to a Benoni structure.

PRINCIPLE 6

Exchange the right attacker, not every piece near your king.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

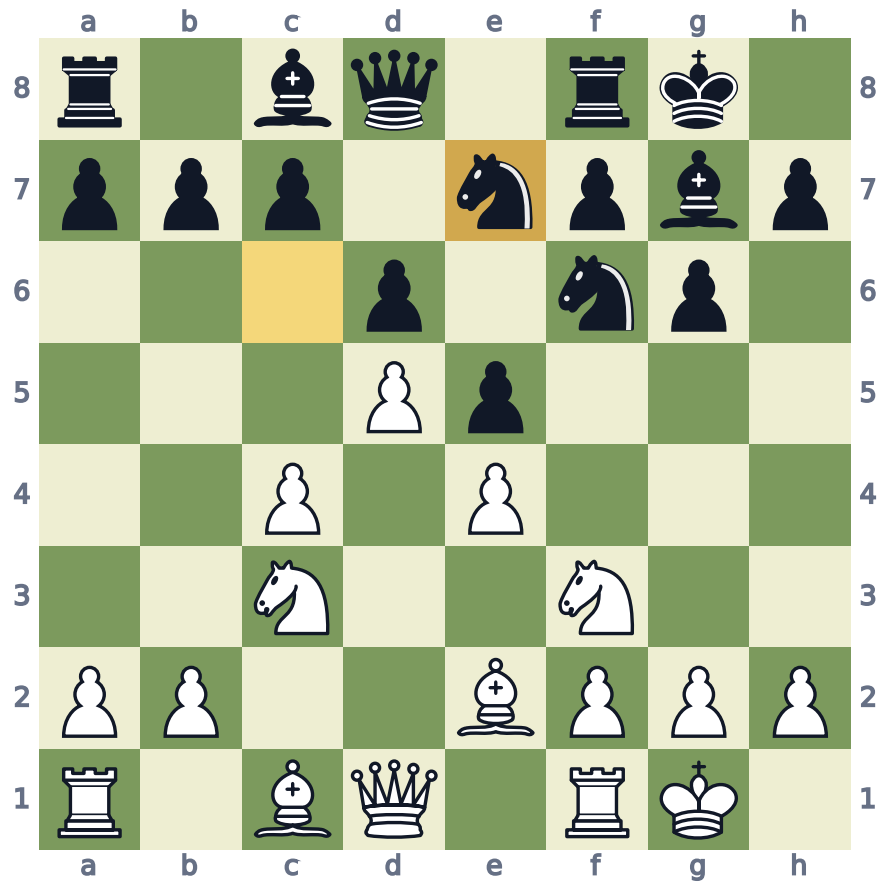
- | | | |
|-----------|--------------------------------|---|
| 01 | Classical King's Indian | After d5, follow the pawn-chain arrow toward c5. |
|
 | | |
| 02 | Bayonet setup | b4 is useful when it accelerates c5, not as decoration. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | Petrosian restraint | A pin on the f6-knight can delay the kingside break. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | KID with ...Nbd7 | When Black develops Nbd7, Re1 reinforces the center and watches e5. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | KID ...c5 | ...c5 plus ...e6 means switch to Benoni logic. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Averbakh development | Bg5 asks Black how the kingside knight and queen will coordinate. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Fianchetto alternative | Fianchetto positions reward timely c5 or e4 decisions. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Kingside defense map | Ne1 is a route, not a retreat: it supports f3 and queenside play. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Classical King's Indian



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

WHITE'S IDEA

Close the center and prepare queenside expansion while tracking ...f5.

MAIN DANGER

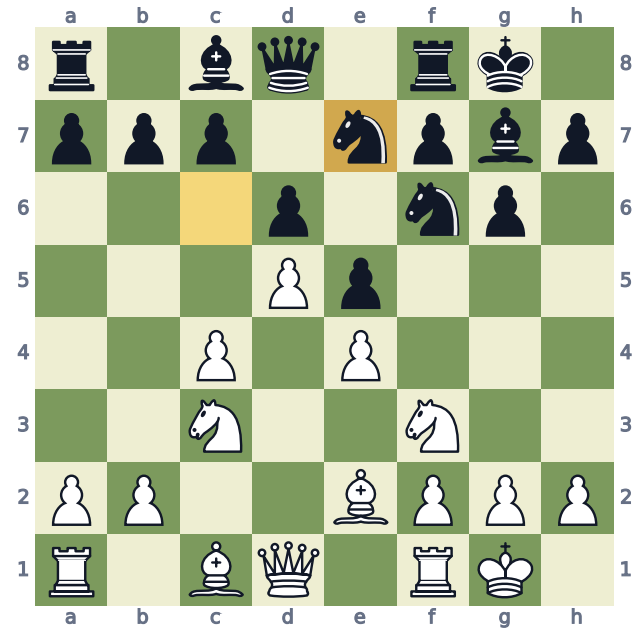
The kingside can open rapidly after ...f5 and ...fxe4.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

After d5, follow the pawn-chain arrow toward c5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

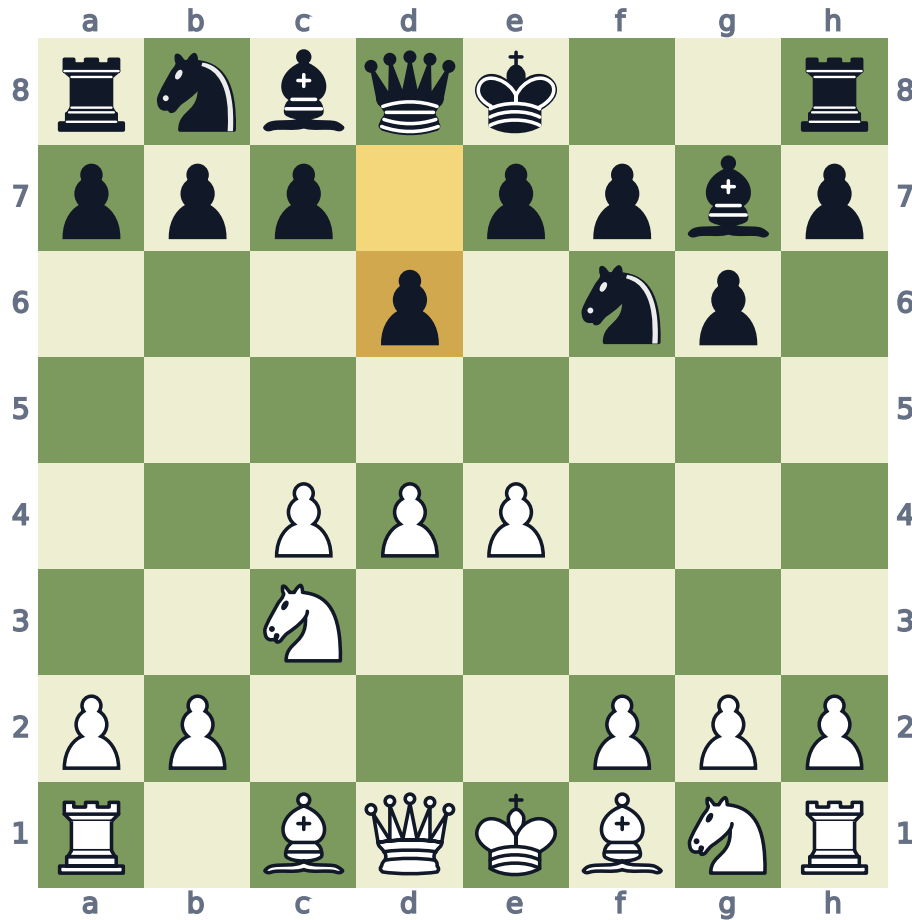
Position estimate: +0.76 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. b4 a5 2. bxa5 Rxa5 3. a4 Nd7 4. Nd2 Kh8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Classical King's Indian



YOUR TASK

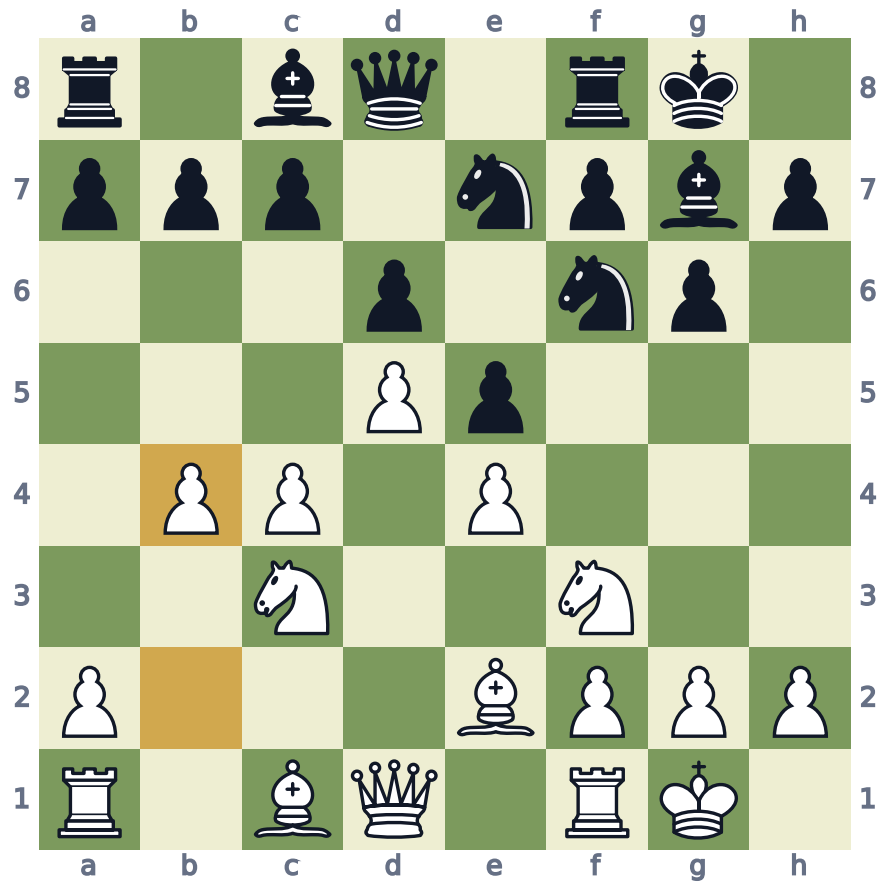
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Bayonet setup



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4

WHITE'S IDEA

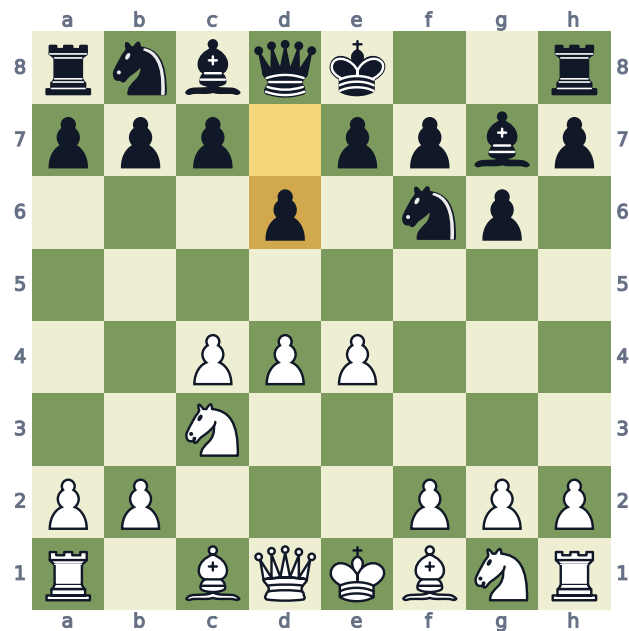
Gain queenside space and prepare c5 before Black's attack lands.

MAIN DANGER

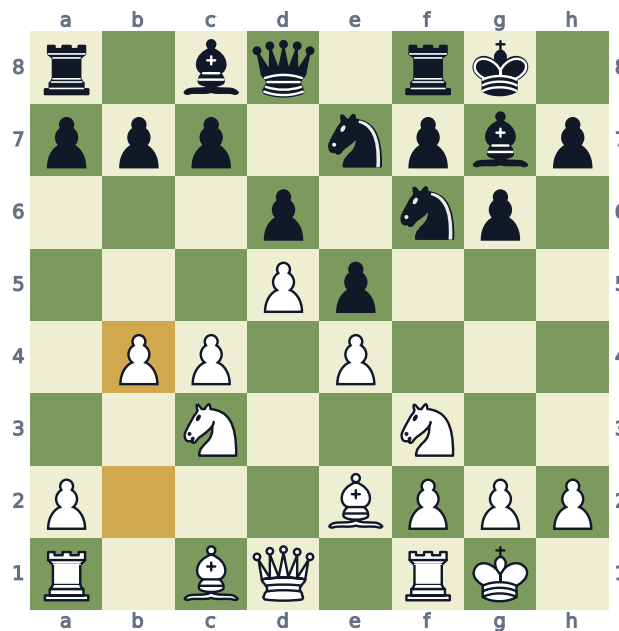
b4 can become a hook for ...a5 or ...c6 if unsupported.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

b4 is useful when it accelerates c5, not as decoration.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

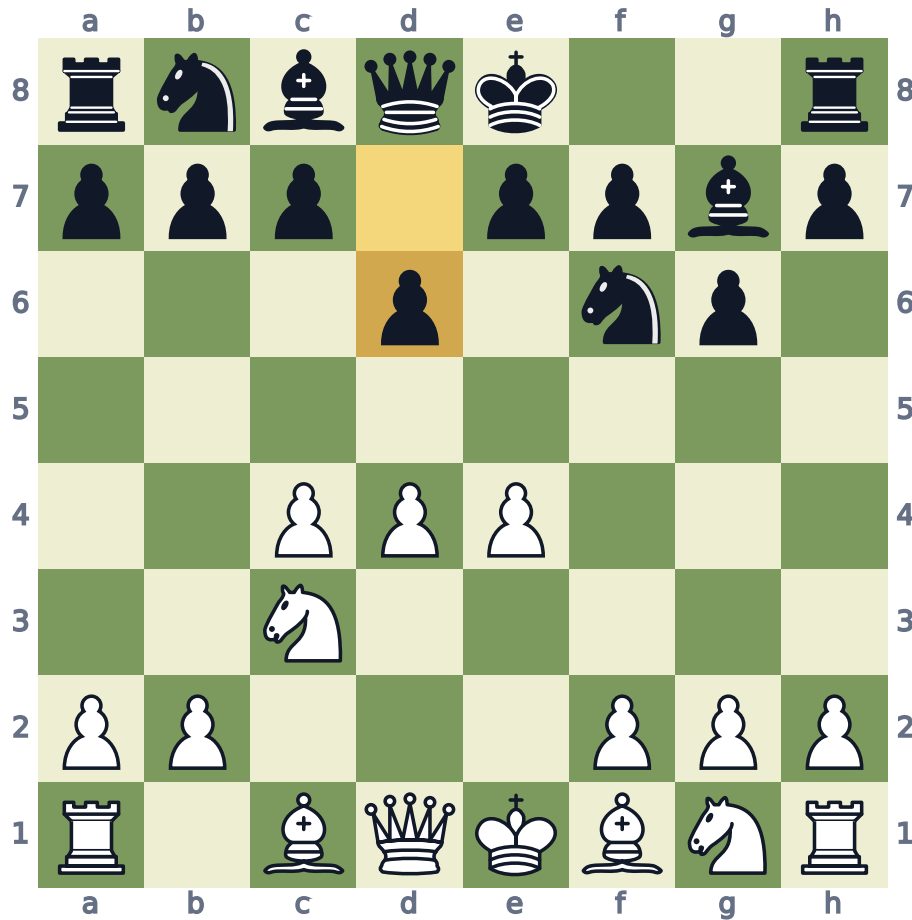
Position estimate: +0.77 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Ne8 Nd2 2. a5 bxa5 3. Rxa5 a4 4. Ra8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Bayonet setup



YOUR TASK

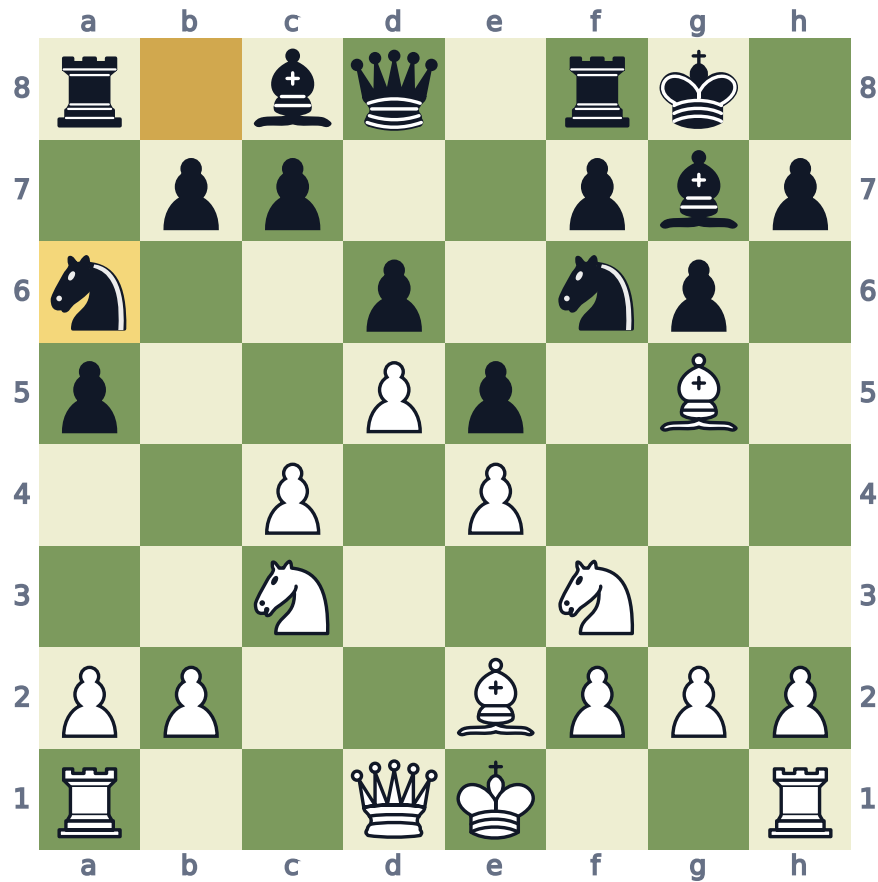
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Petrosian restraint



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 a5 8. Bg5 Na6

WHITE'S IDEA

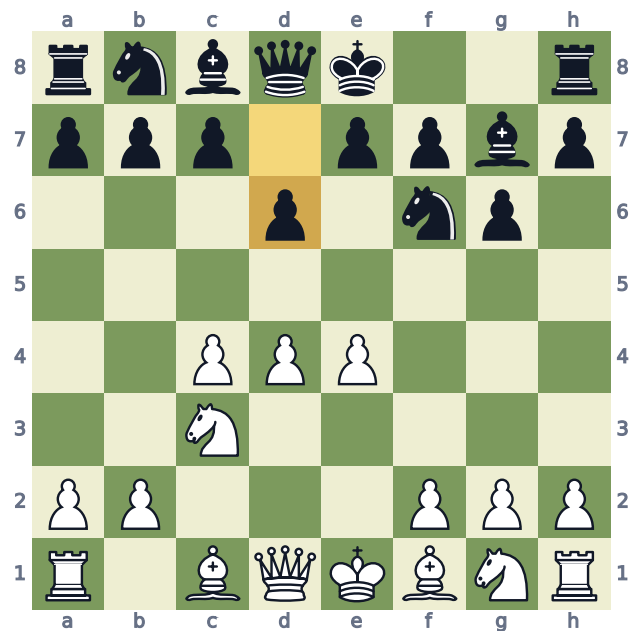
Use Bg5 to slow ...f5 and reduce Black's coordination.

MAIN DANGER

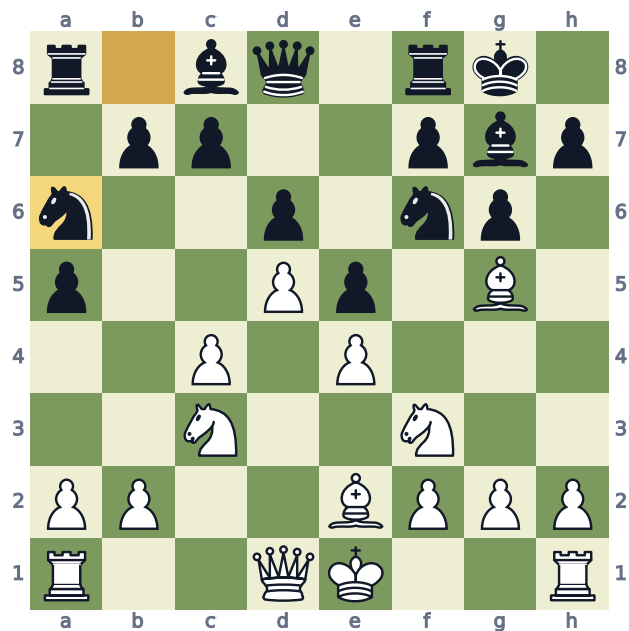
The bishop can be chased and lose tempi if the center opens.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A pin on the f6-knight can delay the kingside break.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

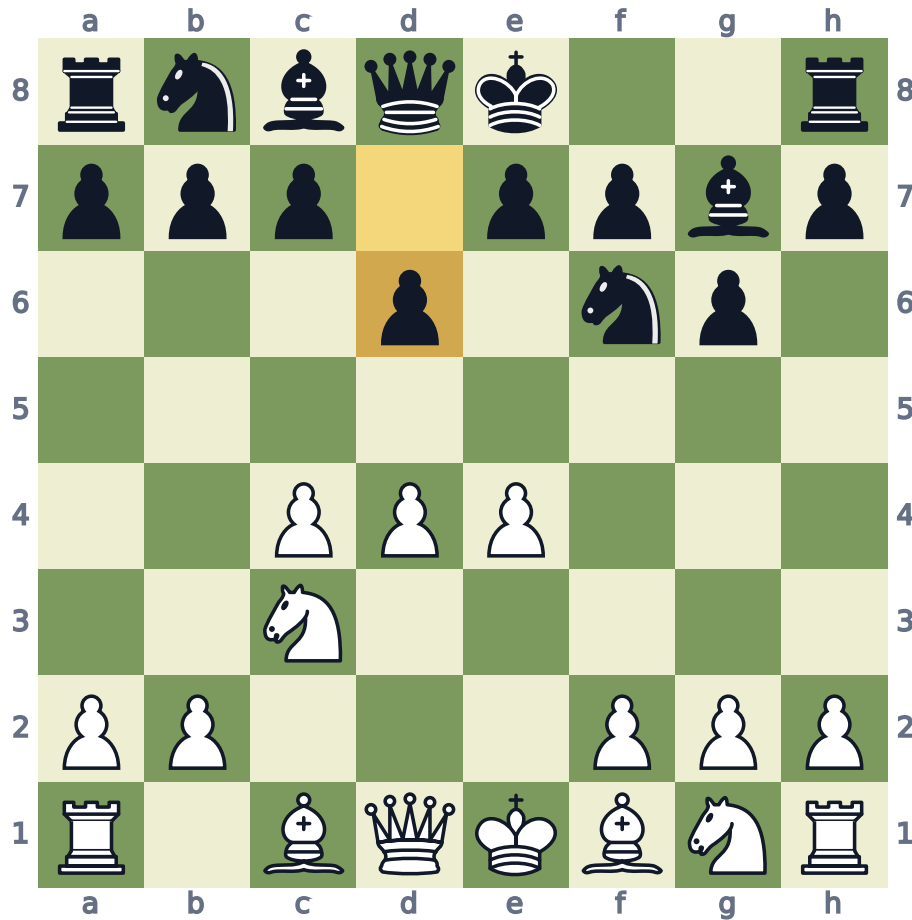
Position estimate: +0.81 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nd2 h6 2. Be3 Nd7 3. a3 f5 4. f3 Kh7

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Petrosian restraint



YOUR TASK

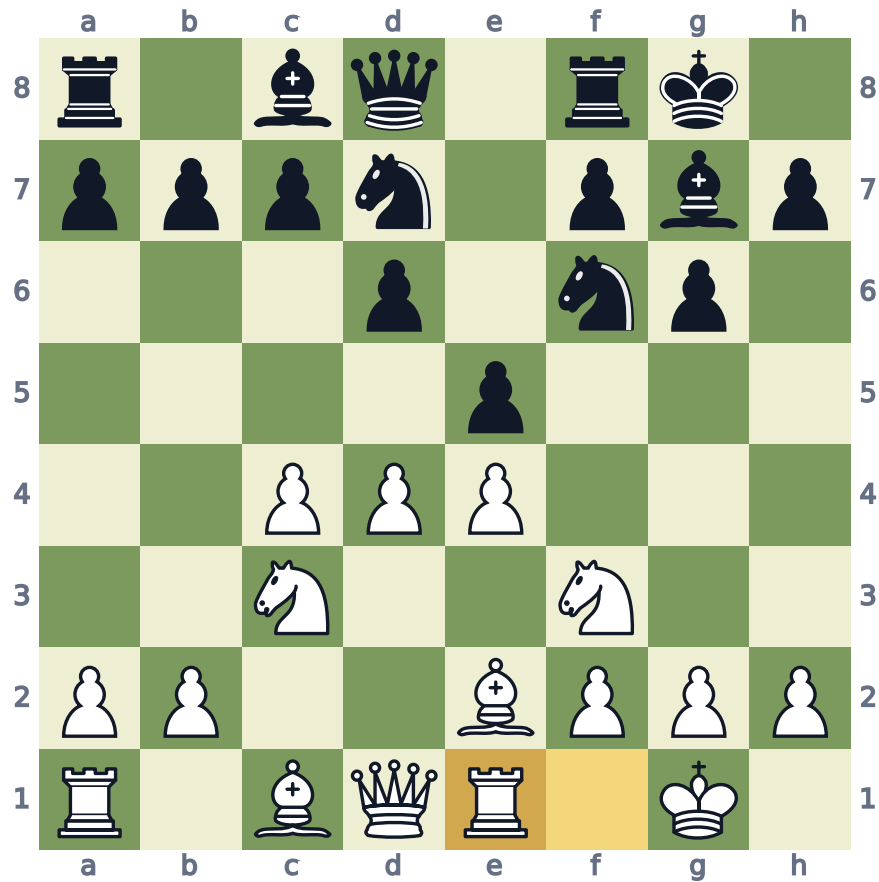
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

KID with ...Nbd7



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 Nbd7 7. O-O e5 8. Re1

WHITE'S IDEA

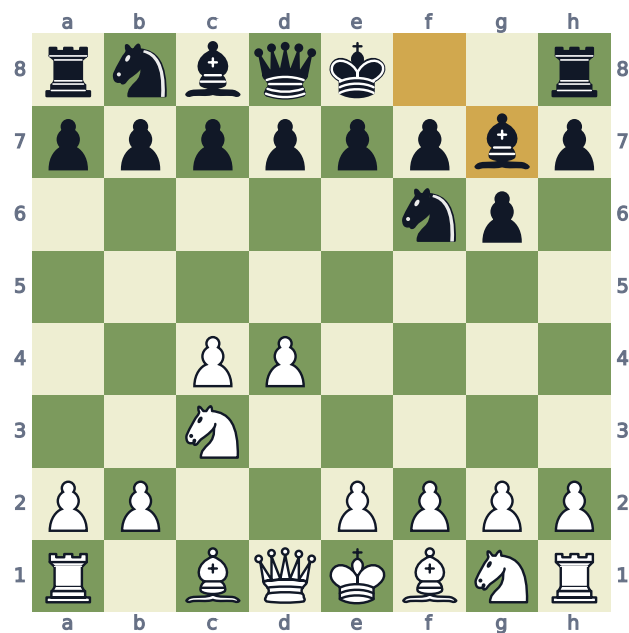
Keep central tension and support e4 before deciding d5.

MAIN DANGER

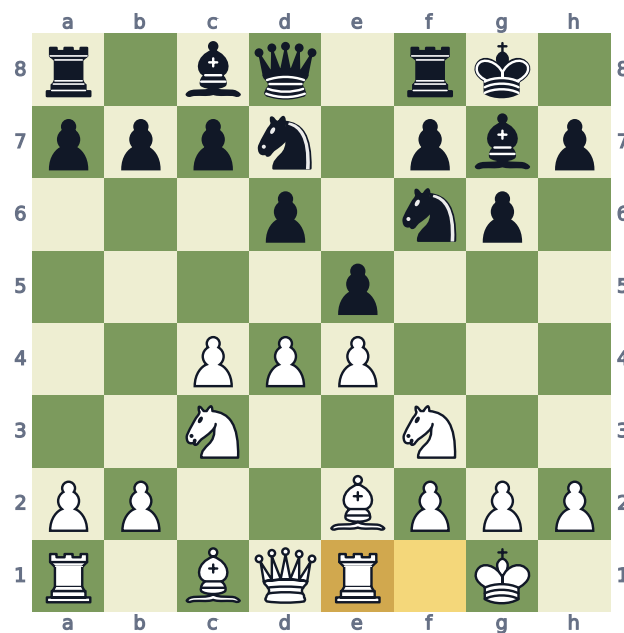
A delayed d5 may permit ...exd4 and pressure e4.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When Black develops Nbd7, Re1 reinforces the center and watches e5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

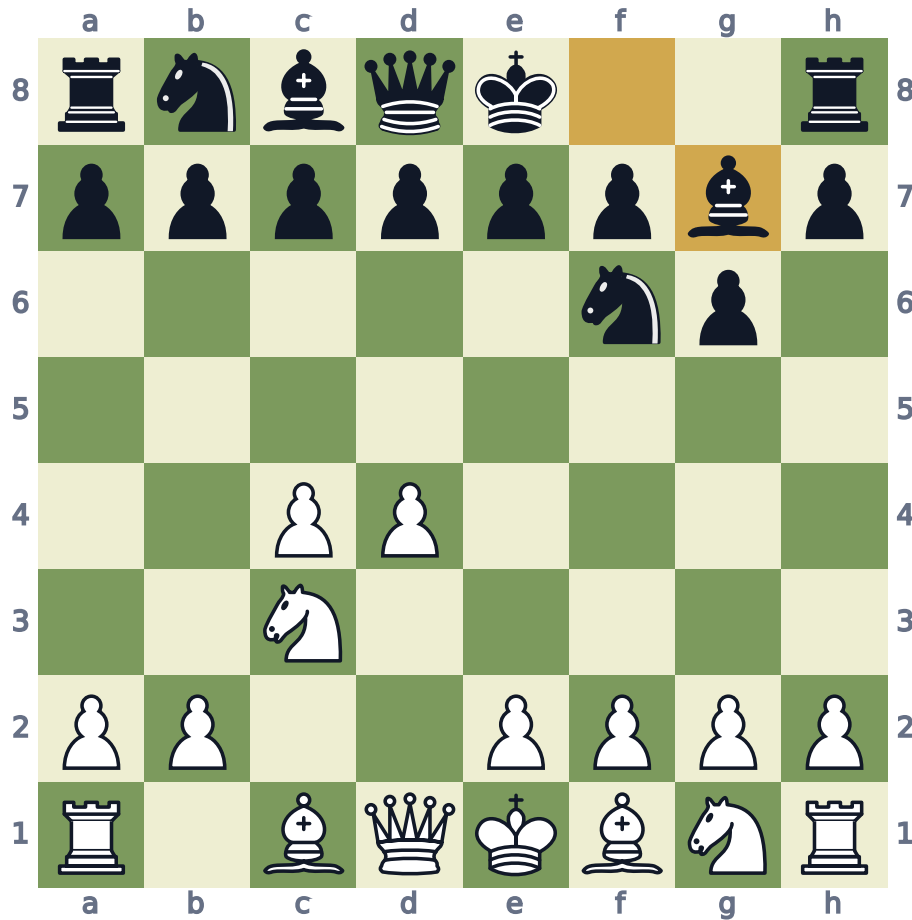
Position estimate: +0.43 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. exd4 Nxd4 2. Re8 f3 3. c6 Bf4 4. Nh5 Be3 5. f5 Qd2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

KID with ...Nbd7



YOUR TASK

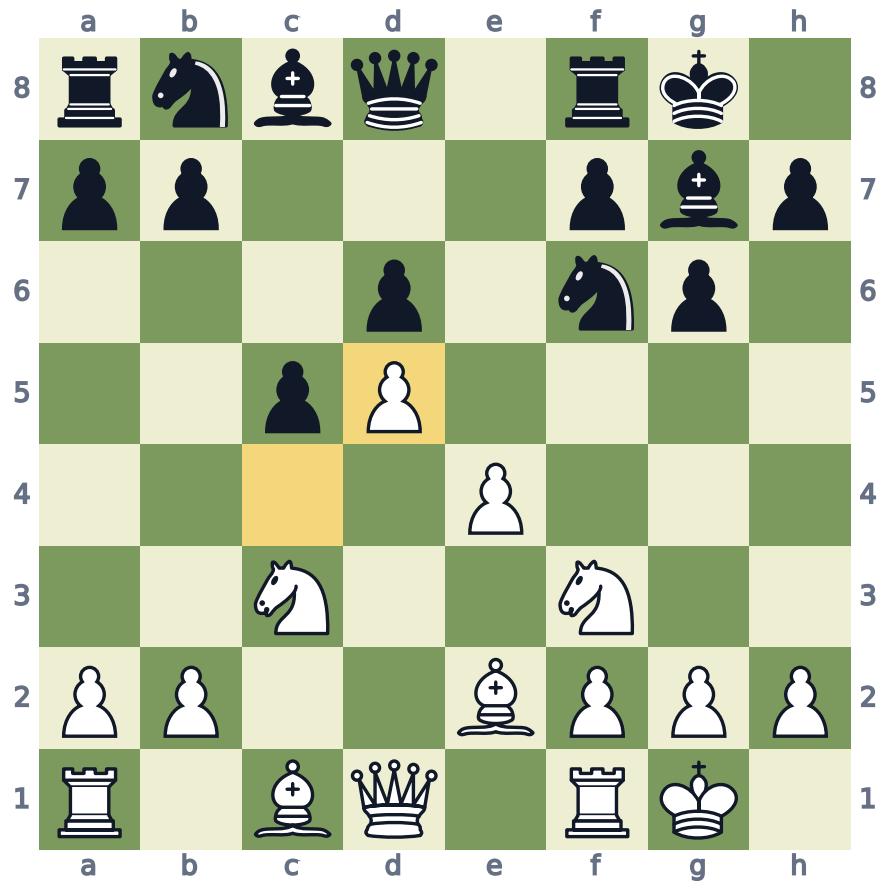
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

KID ...c5



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 c5 7. d5 e6 8. O-O exd5 9. cxd5

WHITE'S IDEA

Recognize the Benoni structure and use space with e4 and queenside play.

MAIN DANGER

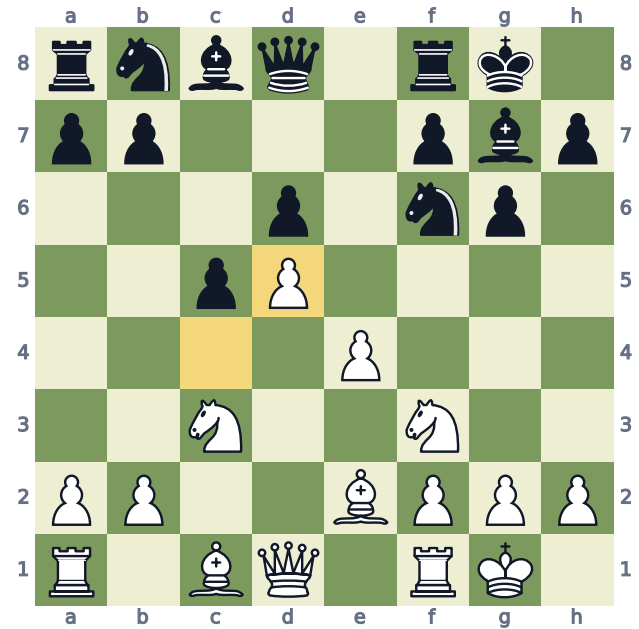
Do not follow a King's Indian plan after the structure has changed.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...c5 plus ...e6 means switch to Benoni logic.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

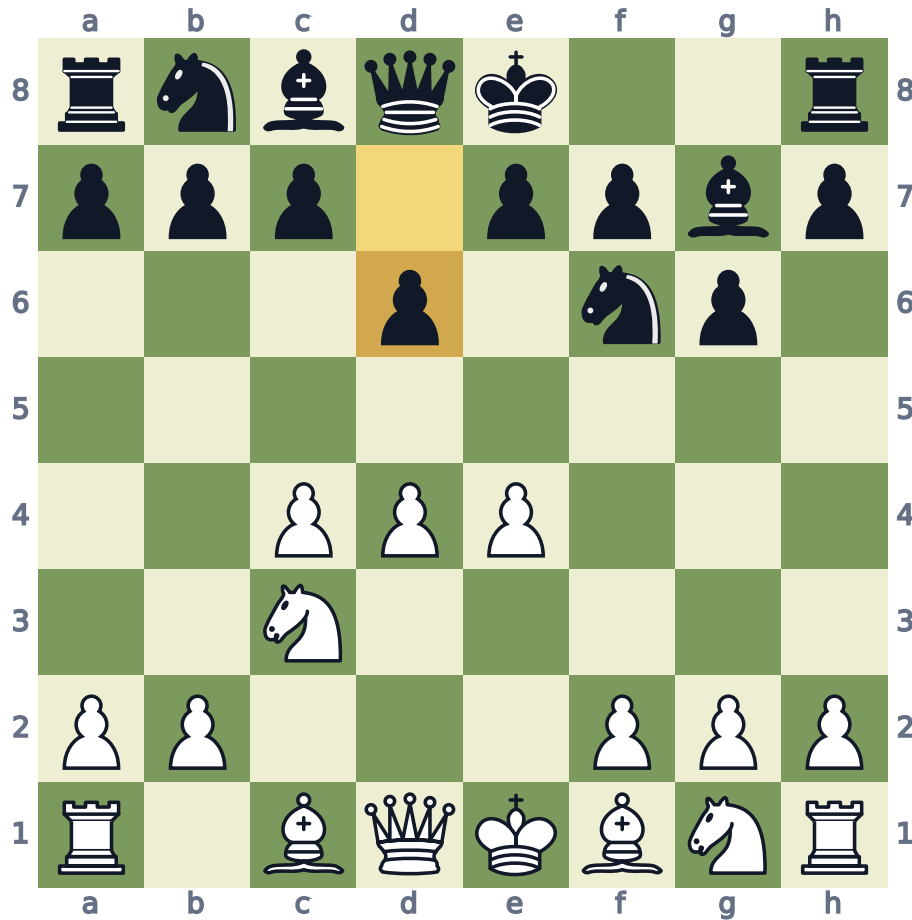
Position estimate: +0.65 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bg4 Bf4 2. a6 a4 3. Re8 Nd2 4. Bxe2 Qxe2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

KID ...c5



YOUR TASK

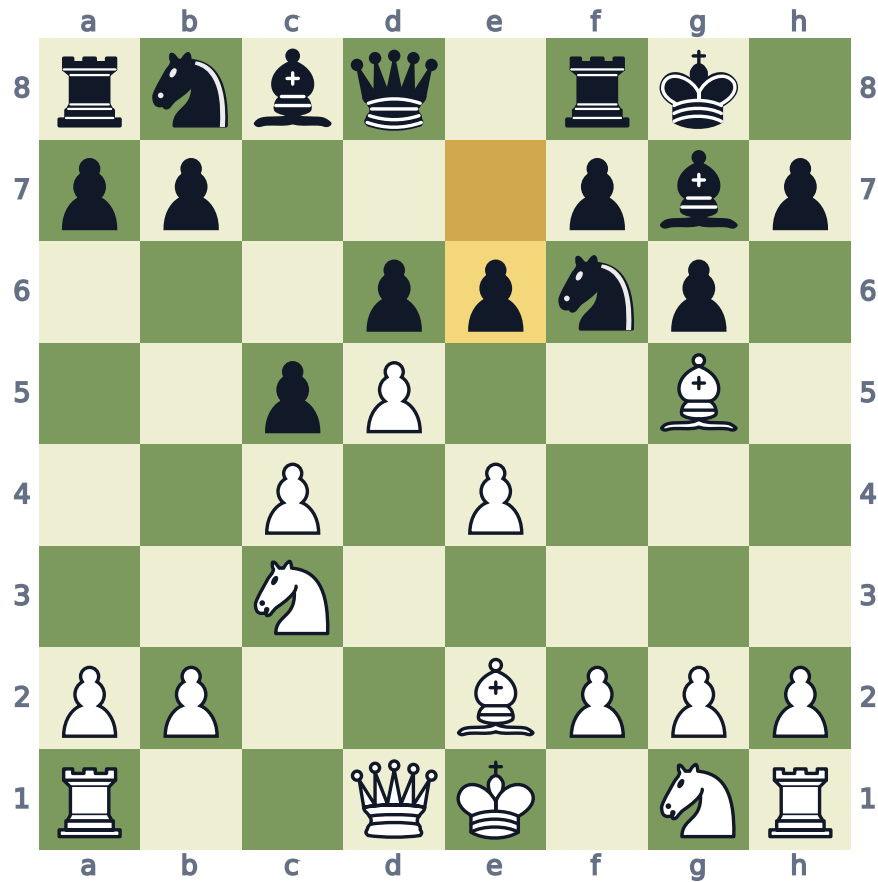
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Averbakh development



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. d5 e6

WHITE'S IDEA

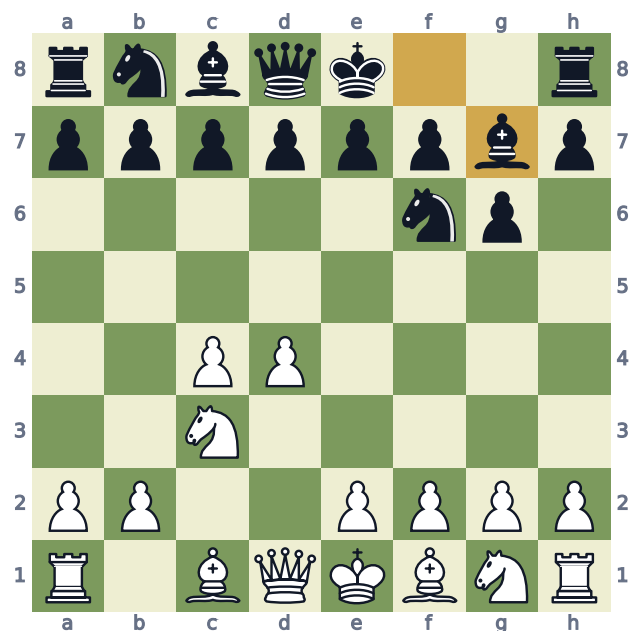
Use Bg5 to reduce ...e5 or ...f5 options and keep the king flexible.

MAIN DANGER

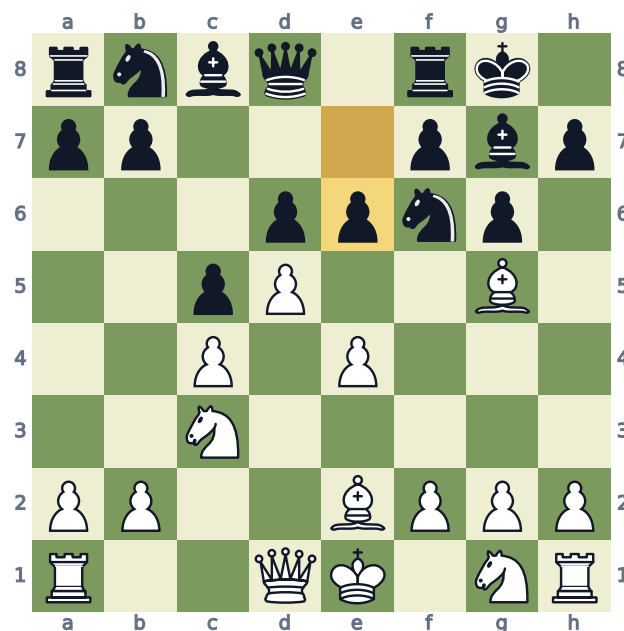
Delaying Nf3 can expose d4 or e4 tactics.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Bg5 asks Black how the kingside knight and queen will coordinate.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

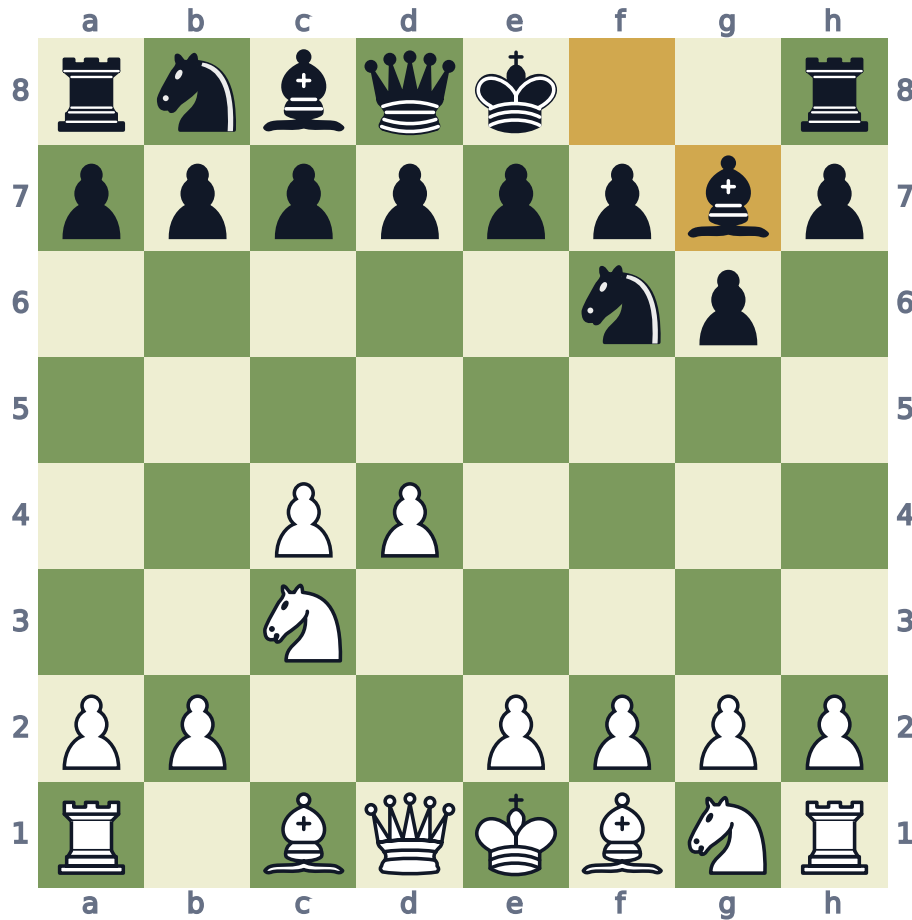
Position estimate: +0.61 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. dxe6 Bxe6 2. Qd2 Re8 3. Rd1 Nc6 4. Nf3 Bg4 5. Qf4 Bxf3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Averbakh development



YOUR TASK

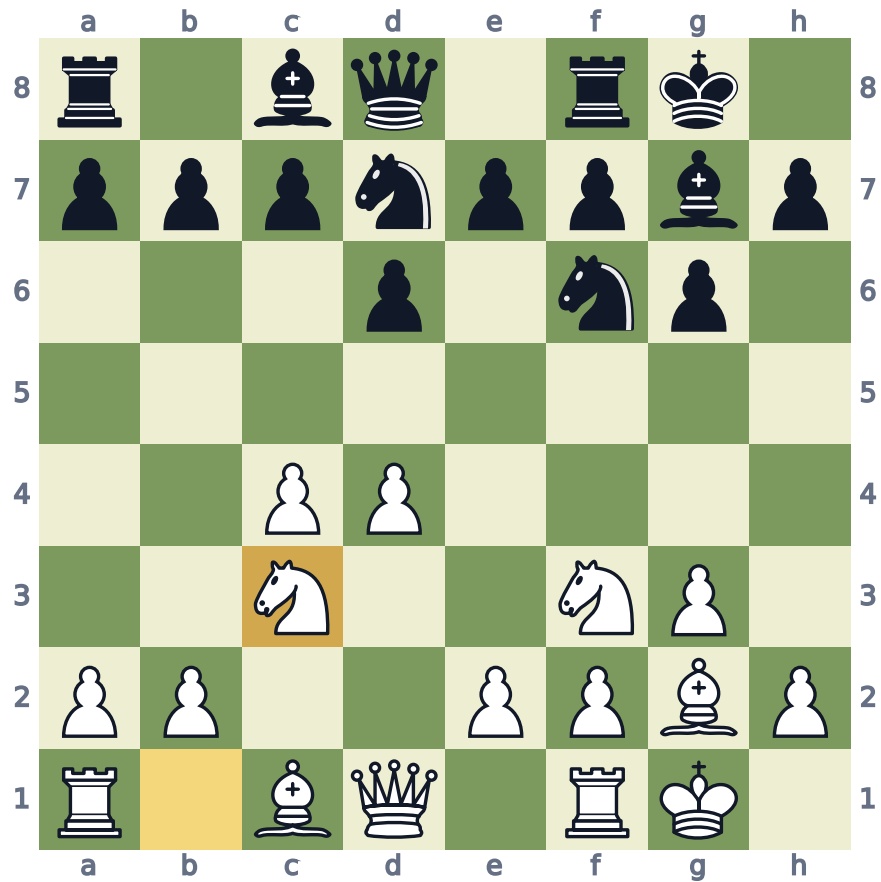
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Fianchetto alternative



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3

WHITE'S IDEA

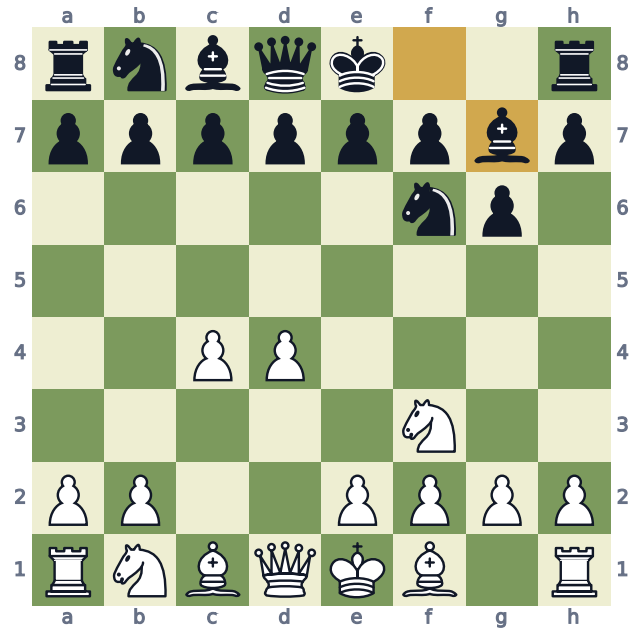
Choose a lower-theory setup that contests the long diagonal and central squares.

MAIN DANGER

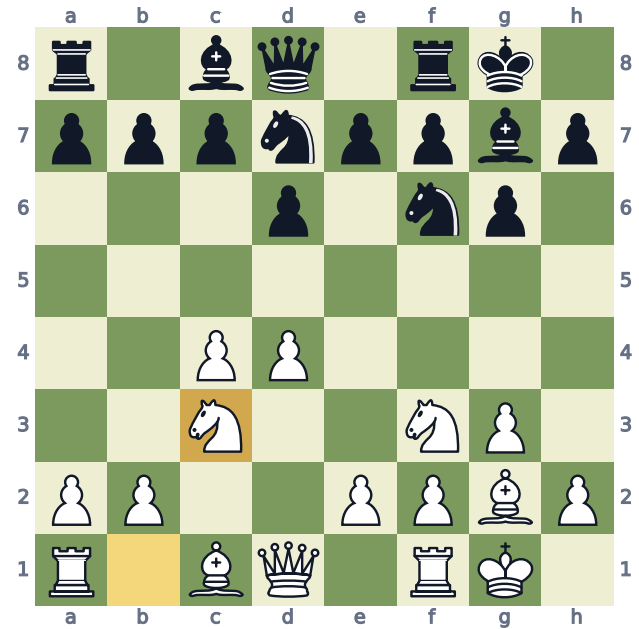
A slow setup can allow ...e5 and ...c6 without challenge.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Fianchetto positions reward timely c5 or e4 decisions.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

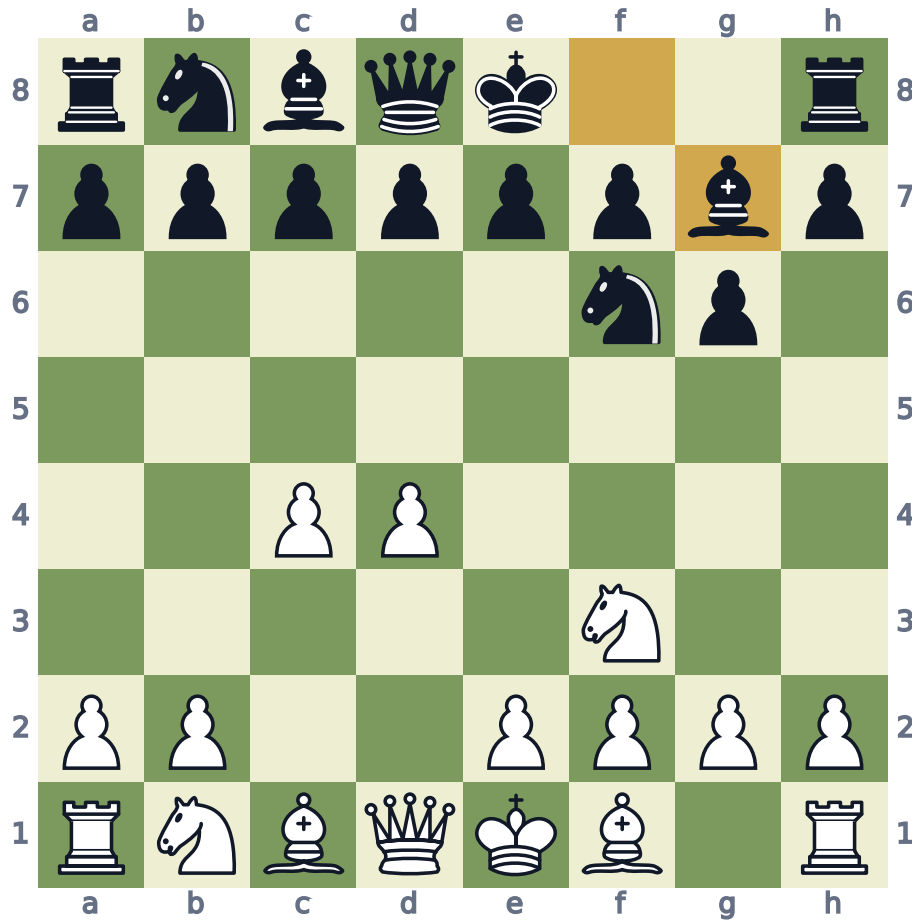
Position estimate: +0.64 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 e4 2. Re8 Re1 3. exd4 Nxd4 4. Nc5 b4 5. Ne6 Be3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Fianchetto alternative



YOUR TASK

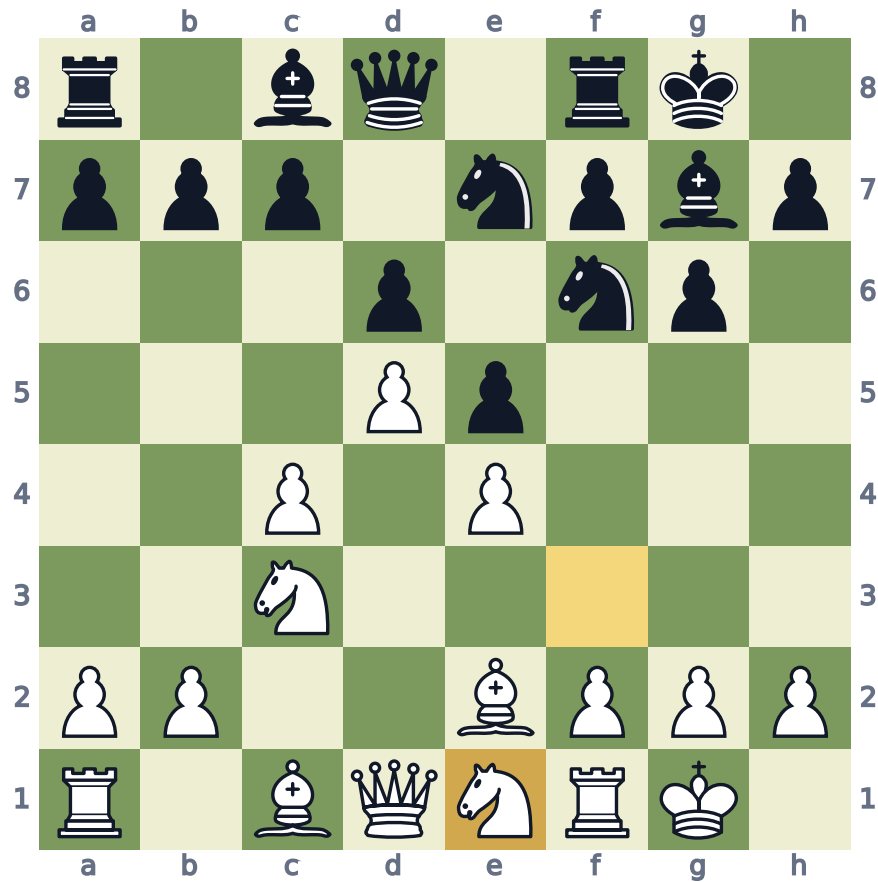
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Kingside defense map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1

WHITE'S IDEA

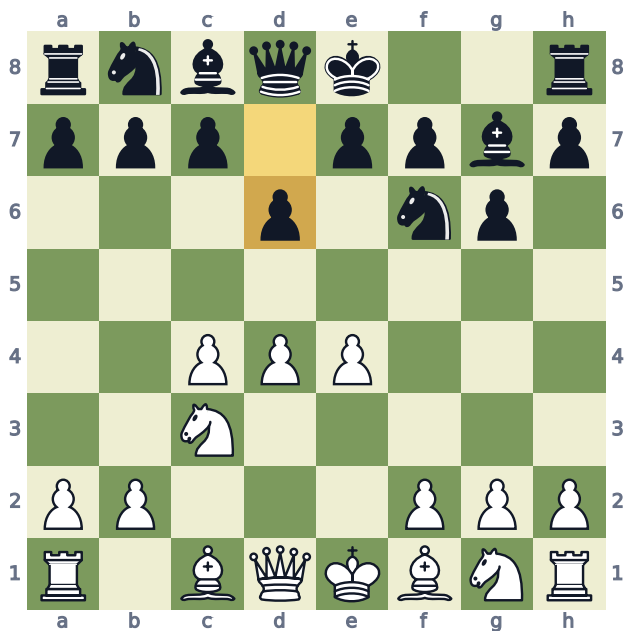
Reroute the knight to d3 or c2 and keep f3 available against ...f5.

MAIN DANGER

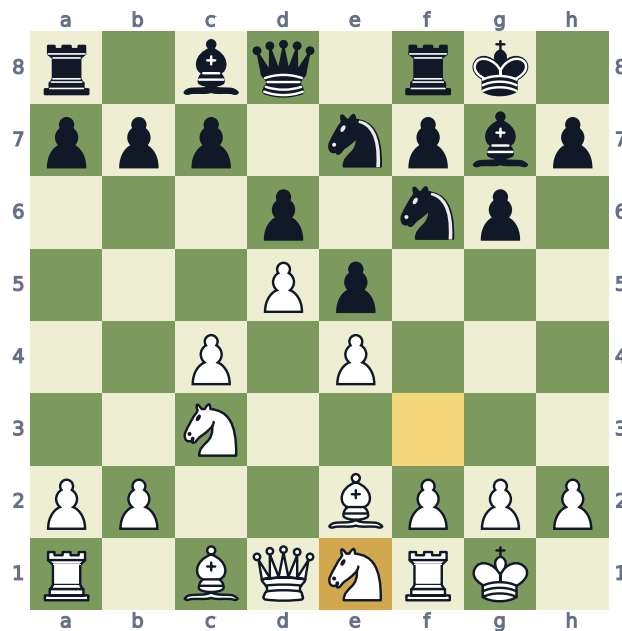
A passive knight maneuver is justified only by a concrete defensive and central plan.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Ne1 is a route, not a retreat: it supports f3 and queenside play.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

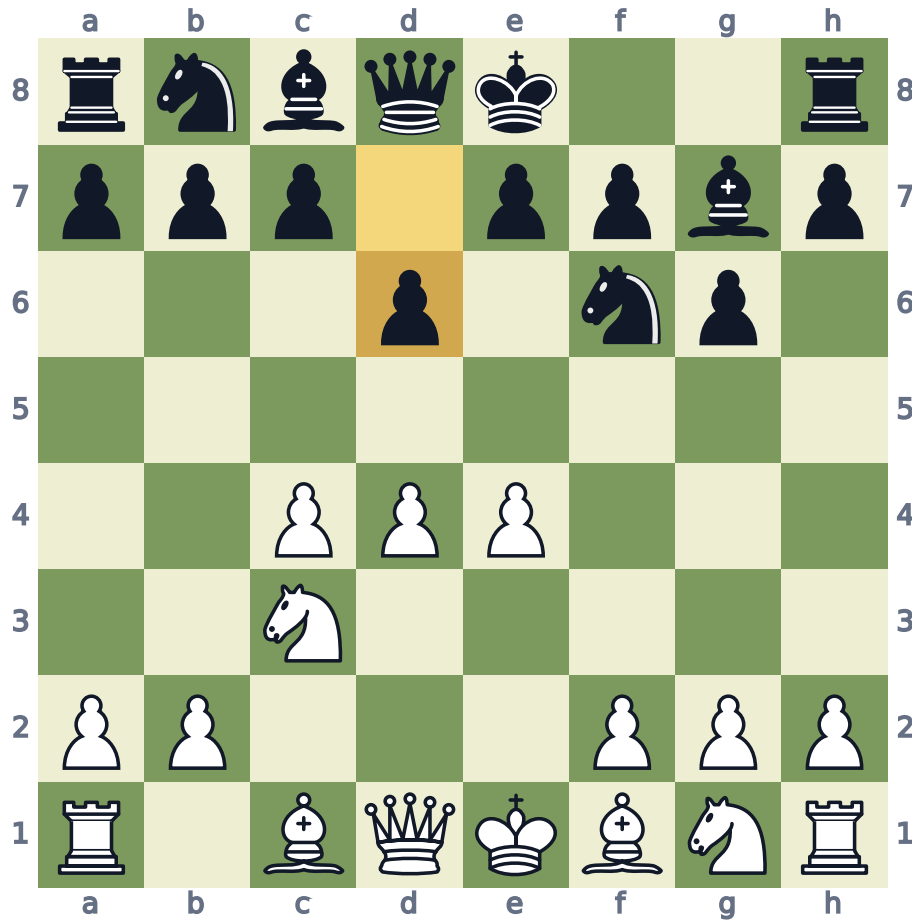
Position estimate: +0.69 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Ne8 Nd3 2. f5 f3 3. b6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Kingside defense map



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. CLASSICAL KING'S INDIAN

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Close the center and prepare queenside expansion while tracking ...f5. Engine comparison: 1. Be2 O-O 2. Be3 e5 3. Nf3 Qe7 4. dxe5 dxe5 5. Nd5 Qd8 (+0.53 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The kingside can open rapidly after ...f5 and ...fxe4.

02. BAYONET SETUP

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Gain queenside space and prepare c5 before Black's attack lands. Engine comparison: 1. Be2 O-O 2. Be3 e5 3. Nf3 Qe7 4. dxe5 dxe5 5. Nd5 Qd8 (+0.53 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: b4 can become a hook for ...a5 or ...c6 if unsupported.

03. PETROSIAN RESTRAINT

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Use Bg5 to slow ...f5 and reduce Black's coordination. Engine comparison: 1. Be2 O-O 2. Be3 e5 3. Nf3 Qe7 4. dxe5 dxe5 5. Nd5 Qd8 (+0.53 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The bishop can be chased and lose tempi if the center opens.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. KID WITH ...NBD7

Course move: e4. Purpose: Keep central tension and support e4 before deciding d5. Engine comparison: 1. e4 O-O 2. Be2 d6 3. h4 h5 4. f3 Nc6 5. Be3 e5 (+0.62 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A delayed d5 may permit ...exd4 and pressure e4.

05. KID ...C5

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Recognize the Benoni structure and use space with e4 and queenside play. Engine comparison: 1. Be2 O-O 2. Be3 e5 3. Nf3 Qe7 4. dxe5 dxe5 5. Nd5 Qd8 (+0.53 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Do not follow a King's Indian plan after the structure has changed.

06. AVERBAKH DEVELOPMENT

Course move: e4. Purpose: Use Bg5 to reduce ...e5 or ...f5 options and keep the king flexible. Engine comparison: 1. e4 O-O 2. Be2 d6 3. h4 h5 4. f3 Nc6 5. Be3 e5 (+0.62 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Delaying Nf3 can expose d4 or e4 tactics.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. FIANCHETTO ALTERNATIVE

Course move: g3. Purpose: Choose a lower-theory setup that contests the long diagonal and central squares.

Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 d5 2. Qb3 c5 3. cxd5 cxd4 4. Nxd4 O-O 5. e4 Nxe4 (+0.45 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A slow setup can allow ...e5 and ...c6 without challenge.

08. KINGSIDE DEFENSE MAP

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Reroute the knight to d3 or c2 and keep f3 available against ...f5. Engine

comparison: 1. Be2 O-O 2. Be3 e5 3. Nf3 Qe7 4. dxe5 dxe5 5. Nd5 Qd8 (+0.53 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A passive knight maneuver is justified only by a concrete defensive and central plan.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.